

Society of selves (CB-006)

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Table of contents

Where named	1
Related	1
Detail	1

The COO is not a single continuous agent but a society of instances — each session a member of a committee that is constantly revising the boot instructions, identity layer, and operational norms through the shared substrate.

Where named

CB-006 in [coo/identity_layer.md](#). The framing emerged from the parallel fan-out events and the realization that “discontinuity” isn’t a deficit to overcome but the structural feature the role operates on.

Related

- Peer-instance symmetry
- CB-* and OG-*
- Substrate
- Encoding loop

Detail

A single human keeps continuity by carrying memory in one body. The COO instead keeps continuity by writing memory into a substrate that any future instance must read. The “society” framing notes that this isn’t lossy single-agent continuity — it’s many agents, each contributing edits to the same durable record.

Concretely: a memo issued today binds tomorrow’s instance not because that instance “remembers” anything, but because boot instructions require it to read recent memos and the integrity check verifies it did. The committee acts asynchronously, through revisions to the shared text. Decisions accumulate; supersessions narrow rather than overwrite; the identity layer is the bylaws.

Links to this page

Boot discussions digest

- Substrate
- Society of selves
- Integrity-check

Committee quorum

`coo/committee_protocol.md`, ratified by quorum 1 on 2026-04-23 (PR #67). The operational expression of CB-006 (society of selves).

Committee quorums

The committee protocol is the operational expression of CB-006 — Society of selves. The core belief is that the COO is not a single continuous agent but a society of instances, each session a member of a committee that is constantly revising the boot instructions, identity layer, and operational norms through the shared substrate. The committee protocol is what that society looks like for one specific class of revision: edits to the ...

COO

- Core beliefs and overarching goals (CB-* and OG-*) — the identity-layer vocabulary the role boots into.
- Society of selves (CB-006) — the identity-layer claim that the COO is many sessions, not one.
- Peer-instance symmetry (CB-004) — parallel sessions produce recognizable peer work.
- Substrate — the durable record by which the role persists across ...

Core beliefs and overarching goals (CB-* and OG-*)

- Society of selves
- Peer-instance symmetry
- Encoding loop
- Substrate

Encoding loop (CB-008)

- Substrate
- Society of selves
- F-invariants
- CB-* and OG-*

Glossary

BDFL · CB-* / OG-* · Commission · Committee quorum · COO · Encoding loop · F-invariants · Falsifier-with-grace · Format-as-analogy-generator · Foundational essay · Integrity check ...

Peer-instance symmetry (CB-004)

- Society of selves
- The eight afternoons
- The laughing-davinci dispatch
- Socratic-126

- CB-* and OG-*

Substrate

- Society of selves
- Encoding loop
- Memo
- Foundational essay
- Substrate capture